WazobiaAssist
Government answers in one place

Team Profile

The people building WazobiaAssist: bios, affiliations and roles.

Challenge	National AI Innovation Challenge (NAIC) 2026 · Problem Statement 02: Voice-First Access · Track B (Innovation & Enterprise)
Try it	wazobiaassist.github.io · Telegram @WazobiaAssist_bot
Code	github.com/marshalwahlexyz1/wazobiaassist
Date	14 October 2026

#	Name	Role	Affiliation
1	Olawale Amos Akanji	Team lead and AI engineer	Boston University
2	Umar Mamman Toro	Language and translation lead	Miva Open University; Digital Encode
3	Joseph Abah	Domain content lead	NNPC Limited
4	Nwaikwu Ekenedilichukwu Sebastian	User testing and outreach lead	Inspirive Technologies

1. Olawale Amos Akanji: Team lead and AI engineer

- **Affiliation:** Boston University, Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering (PhD candidate, Computer Engineering: Security and Privacy)
- **Location:** Boston, Massachusetts
- **Responsibilities:** leads the project; built the N-ATLaS pipeline, speech recognition, retrieval, web page and Telegram bot; runs the GPU server and deployment.
- **Relevant experience:** builds Transformer-based models that detect financial scams in conversations and run on the phone. Led an LLM-assisted review of 434 consumer-lending apps that led to the removal of 93 apps with more than 300 million users (ACM AsiaCCS 2026). Eleven years as a cybersecurity specialist in the Nigerian Air Force, and founder of a Nigerian non-profit that teaches young people to avoid fraud. BSc Cybersecurity, Air Force Institute of Technology, Kaduna (overall best graduating student).
- **Languages:** Yorùbá, English

2. Umar Mamman Toro: Language and translation lead

- **Affiliation:** Miva Open University (Master of Information Technology); Information Security Consultant, Digital Encode
- **Location:** Surulere, Lagos
- **Responsibilities:** reviews Hausa, Igbo and Yorùbá questions and answers as a native speaker; checks that N-ATLaS translations keep the meaning, names and codes right; writes the test questions in each language.
- **Relevant experience:** Master of Information Technology with a specialisation in Artificial Intelligence; works as an information security consultant.
- **Languages:** Hausa, Yorùbá, English

3. Joseph Abah: Domain content lead

- **Affiliation:** NNPC Limited
- **Location:** Abuja, FCT
- **Responsibilities:** collects and checks the official sources for every domain: identity, voting, money and scams (NIMC, INEC, CBN, EFCC), health, farming and education (NPHCDA, WHO, IITA, JAMB); owns the safety rules (no doses, no diagnosis, danger signs go to a health facility).
- **Relevant experience:** Three years in IT security.
- **Languages:** Idoma, English

4. Nwaikwu Ekenedilichukwu Sebastian: User testing and outreach lead

- **Affiliation:** Inspirive Technologies, IT Support Engineer
- **Location:** [Ikoyi, Lagos]
- **Responsibilities:** recruits testers through WhatsApp groups and communities, collects feedback and testing evidence, produces the demo video, and leads the plan to reach 1,000 users.
- **Relevant experience:** Manages user accounts, access controls, identity management, and enterprise IT resources.
- **Languages:** Igbo, Pidgin, English